TECH NEXUS

Hackathon (Innovation Sprint)

Teams design, build, and pitch a functional software/hardware prototype that solves a real-world problem statement released at the opening ceremony, within a fixed development window.

Rules & Specifications

Team Composition	Minimum 3, maximum 5 members per team. All members must be currently enrolled university/college students.
Duration & Format	2-hour on-site hackathon. Problem statements/tracks are revealed at the opening ceremony; no prior development on the submitted idea is allowed.
Tech Stack	Any programming language, framework, or hardware platform may be used. Use of open-source libraries and public APIs is permitted, provided it is disclosed at submission.
Originality Rule	All code and design work must be produced during the event window. Pre-built projects, templates, or previously published code (beyond disclosed libraries) are not allowed and will be disqualified as plagiarism.
Submission Requirements	• A public GitHub/GitLab repository link with complete source code. • A working live demo or recorded walkthrough. • A maximum 3-minute pitch presentation to the judging panel.
Judging Criteria	• Innovation & Originality — 25% • Technical Execution & Functionality — 25% • Real-World Impact & Feasibility — 25% • Presentation & Pitch Clarity — 25%
Conduct & Penalties	• Attacking event Wi-Fi/infrastructure or rival teams' devices leads to immediate disqualification and possible legal action. • Teams must stop coding once time expires; only minor bug fixes are allowed during judging.

General Rules — Applicable to This Category

— Strict Punctuality — Teams must report to their arena, lab, stage, or table 20 minutes before their scheduled heat or session. Late arrival results in automatic forfeit.

— Fair Play & Sportsmanship — Abusive behavior, argument with referees/judges, or unsportsmanlike conduct leads to immediate disqualification.

— Original Work — All code, models, designs, and submissions must be the team's own original work produced within the stated contest window. Plagiarism or use of undisclosed pre-existing material leads to disqualification.

— Network & Infrastructure Integrity — Attacking, disrupting, or attempting unauthorized access to event Wi-Fi, judging platforms, gaming servers, or another team's systems/devices is strictly prohibited and may result in disqualification and legal action.

— Judge's Decision — The decision of the technical panel, head referees, and judges is indisputable and final.

These rules are issued by the Capital Youth Expo Pre-Event BUIC organizing committee. The committee reserves the right to modify rules, time limits, or format if necessary. Judges' decisions are final and non-contestable.